

Nine Ways of Leaving a Room

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One: you say you are going to get water, and you get water, and you come back.

Two: you say you are going to get water.

Three: you stay, and something in you goes and stands in the hall.

Four: you are asked to.

Five: you are not asked to, and this is worse, and you go anyway, slowly, giving them the whole length of the room to stop you.

Six: the ordinary way. Coat, keys, Tuesday.

Seven: you leave the room but not the flat, and for six weeks the two of you conduct a marriage through a wall.

Eight: you die in it, which is the only leaving that does not require the door.

Nine: you come back for the water and they have moved the glass, and you understand that the room has finished with you, and you take your coat.

